whistle connect
FA Referee Management

PRODUCT OVERVIEW

Book Referees. Match Day Ready.

Stream referee bookings to every match.
Schedule availability automatically.
Confirm officials in seconds.
All from one dashboard.

Whistle Connect Ltd.
whistleconnect.co.uk • hello@whistleconnect.co.uk

02

The Challenge

Every weekend, thousands of grassroots matches across the UK face the same problem: finding a qualified referee. County FAs have no centralised system to connect clubs with officials, leaving coaches to coordinate through WhatsApp groups, phone trees, and word of mouth.

73% of coaches cite referee availability as their single biggest operational challenge

5+ hrs per week wasted coordinating officials via calls, texts, and messages

30% of grassroots fixtures impacted by late cancellations or no-shows

The FA's grassroots network covers over 40,000 clubs, 130,000 teams, and nearly 30,000 registered referees. Yet the process of allocating officials to fixtures remains manual, fragmented, and inconsistent across counties. The result: overworked volunteers, unfilled fixtures, and a referee retention crisis.

- No central platform for coaches to search referee availability in real time
- Referees have no visibility of local fixtures needing coverage
- County FAs lack data on booking patterns, referee workload, and coverage gaps
- Last-minute cancellations cascade — one no-show can affect multiple fixtures
- No digital audit trail for bookings, payments, or safeguarding compliance
- Referee recruitment and retention suffers without modern tooling

The Solution

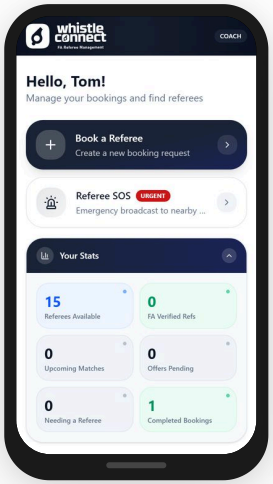
Whistle Connect gives County FAs a single platform to connect every coach with every available referee. Clubs post fixtures, referees set availability, and the system handles matching, offers, confirmations, and messaging — all with built-in FA verification, DBS tracking, and safeguarding compliance. One dashboard replaces the entire coordination chain.

> *One dashboard. Every match. Every referee. Updated in seconds, not hours. Fully auditable. FA compliant.*

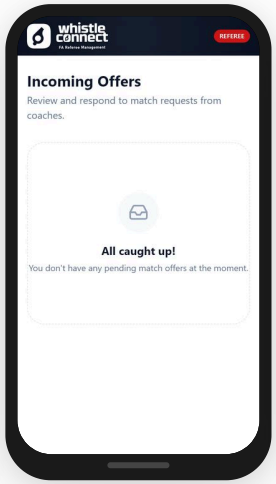
03

One Platform, Three Roles

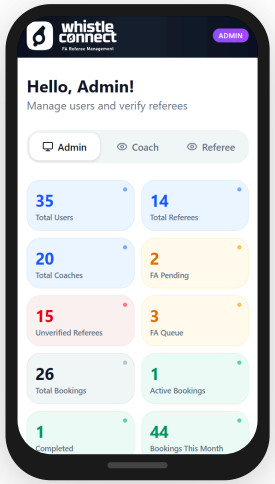
Whistle Connect adapts to each user. Coaches manage bookings and search for officials. Referees handle offers, set availability, and track earnings. Administrators verify credentials, monitor activity, and oversee the entire county network — all from the same platform.



Coach



Referee



Admin

Clean role-specific UI, delivered to coaches, referees and administrators on all devices.

Role-based access | Real-time updates | Mobile-first design | Push notifications

04

Book. Offer. Confirm.

Create a booking with match details, search for available referees by location and rating, then send offers directly. Referees accept with pricing, and your match is confirmed — all within the app.

BOOKING WORKFLOW

Draft → Pending → Offered → Confirmed → Completed

↳ Cancelled

OFFER WORKFLOW

Sent → Accepted & Priced → Accepted

↳ Declined

Supports individual match bookings and central venue / tournament bookings. Budget, age group, format, and required referee level are all captured at creation.

KEY FEATURES

Smart Matching

Automatically surfaces referees who match your match requirements, location, and budget criteria.

Budget Control

Set match fees upfront. Referees propose pricing, coaches approve before confirmation.

Auto-Notifications

Push alerts at every stage — new offer, price submitted, booking confirmed, match day reminders.

Full Audit Trail

Complete history of every booking action, offer, and communication for compliance review.

05

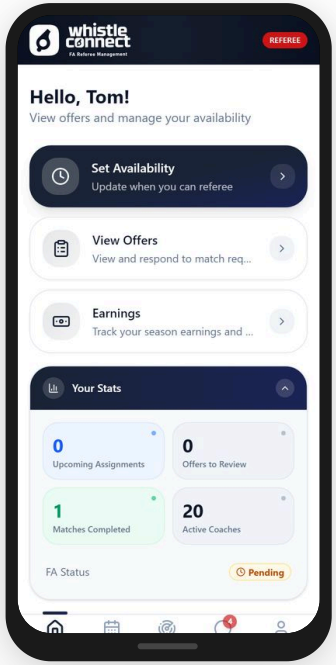
Find Referees Fast, Even Last Minute

The smart search algorithm matches your fixture with the best available referees based on county, distance, availability, and rating. For emergencies, SOS mode broadcasts your match to every nearby official instantly.

- Smart matching by county, availability, travel radius, and rating
- SOS Emergency mode broadcasts to all nearby available referees
- First responder gets auto-assigned — no coordination needed
- Referee profiles show reliability scores and match history
- Travel radius and FA verification filtering
- County-wide coverage across 60+ UK regions

> *Your SOS goes live at 9am. By 9:02, three local referees have seen it. By 9:05, one has accepted and your match is covered. You set it once. Whistle Connect does the rest.*

Smart matching | SOS Emergency | County filtering



06

Empowering Every Referee

Referees get their own tailored experience. Set weekly availability, respond to offers, track season earnings, and build a reputation that coaches can trust. Every completed match adds to a public reliability score.

Set Availability

Weekly recurring and date-specific overrides.

Track Earnings

Season dashboard with monthly breakdown charts.

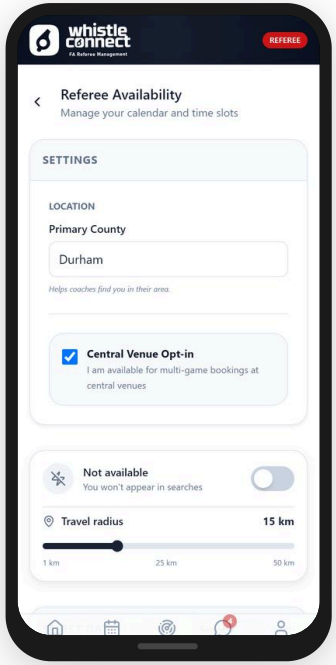
Build Reputation

Ratings and reliability scores visible to all coaches.

Stay Informed

Push notifications for new offers and booking updates.

Season earnings dashboard — track completed matches and income at a glance.



07

FA Verified. Always Compliant.

Every referee on Whistle Connect is verified through the County FA. Our admin verification queue ensures that FA numbers, DBS certificates, and safeguarding qualifications are checked and monitored — giving coaches confidence that every official is qualified.

FA VERIFIED

Qualified • Cleared • Compliant

Every verified referee displays the FA Verified badge on their profile, visible to all coaches during search. Unverified referees are flagged and cannot receive booking offers until cleared.

VERIFICATION PROCESS

1. **Referee Signs Up**
   Submits FA number, DBS status, and safeguarding certificates
2. **Admin Reviews**
   County FA admin verifies credentials in the queue
3. **Profile Activated**
   Badge applied, referee becomes bookable

VERIFICATION AREAS

FA Number Check

Every referee submits their official FA registration number during sign-up. Administrators cross-reference with County FA records before activation.

DBS Tracking

Enhanced DBS clearance status is recorded and monitored. Automated expiry reminders alert administrators before certificates lapse.

Safeguarding

Safeguarding course completion is tracked as part of the verification process. Required for all youth football officiating roles.

Admin Queue

Two-stage verification queue: Awaiting Response and Resolved. One-click approve or reject with automated email notifications to referees.

08

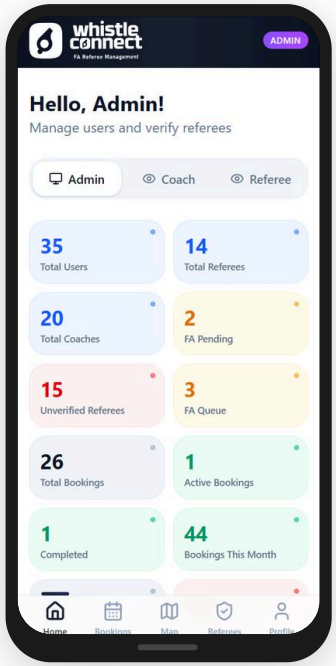
Complete Oversight & Control

County FA administrators get a dedicated dashboard with full visibility of every user, booking, and referee in their region. Analytics, geospatial mapping, and a verification queue make county-level management seamless.

- Real-time stats: total users, referees, coaches, and bookings
- Interactive Mapbox GL map with referee and booking pin locations
- FA verification queue with two-stage workflow
- Coach management with booking counts and activity levels
- Monthly trend tracking and growth analytics
- System-wide notification broadcasting

> *The geospatial Mapbox map shows every active referee and upcoming booking on a live, interactive map. Administrators can identify coverage gaps and ensure every part of the county has adequate official coverage.*

Analytics dashboard | Geospatial map | Referee verification | Booking oversight



Real-Time Analytics
Live metrics on referees, bookings, and match coverage across your county.

Geospatial Map
Mapbox-powered visualisation of referee locations and coverage areas.

Coach Management
Monitor clubs, coaches, and booking patterns for operational insights.

FA Verification Queue
Streamlined approval workflow for new referee applications and renewals.

09

Built for Scale & Security

Whistle Connect is built on a modern, battle-tested stack designed for reliability, performance, and security from day one. Every layer — from authentication to real-time messaging — is production-grade.

Next.js 16
React 19 framework with App Router, server actions, and edge ready.

Supabase
PostgreSQL database with real-time subscriptions, auth, and storage.

Supabase Auth
Authentication built with password-based session management and RLS.

Mapbox GL
Interactive maps with referee locations, rendering live, and coverage dashboards.

Web Push API
VAPID-based push notifications for booking updates and offers.

Vercel
Serverless CDN with edge functions, preview deploys, and global delivery.

Security & Architecture

Row-Level Security
Database-level access control so users can only access their own data.

Role-Based Access
Coach, Referee, and Admin with scoped permissions.

Encrypted Auth
Secure sessions, automatic JWT validation, cookie-based.

Data Isolation
Tenant-scoped data with county-level segregation.

Progressive Web App
Installable, offline-capable, responsive on all devices.

Real-Time Sync
Live updates via Supabase Realtime subscriptions.

Streamlined architecture — full-stack TypeScript with server actions, real-time subscriptions, and zero-config deployments.

Ready to See It in Action?

Book a live demo with the Whistle Connect team. We'll walk you through the dashboard, show you how booking works, and set up a test match in under five minutes.

60+	14	24/7
UK Counties	Age Groups Configured	Real-Time Booking

> *Your brand on every match. Managed by Whistle Connect.*

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